UNDER-REVIEW

Hands-Only CPR & AED Orientation

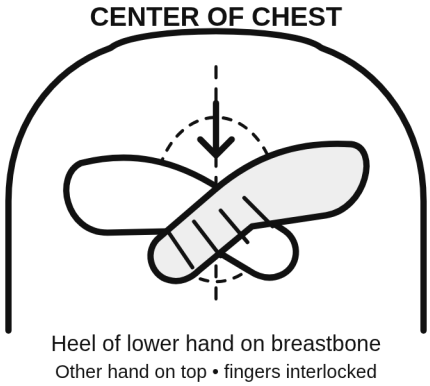
Practice with an instructor. This companion supports skills training and later review; it is not a course, a skills test, or CPR/AED certification.

× DANGER — STOP NOW

Under review—do not publish as medical instruction. A currently qualified CPR/AED instructor or medical professional must review this handout before release. In an emergency, follow the emergency call-taker and AED prompts.

IF A TEEN OR ADULT SUDDENLY COLLAPSES

1. **Check the scene.** Stop and look for traffic, fire, electricity, violence, falling material, water, or other danger. Do not enter an unsafe scene. Use available protective equipment without delaying lifesaving care.
2. **Check response and breathing.** Tap both shoulders and shout. If the person does not respond and is not breathing normally—or is only gasping—treat this as cardiac arrest. Do not spend more than 10 seconds checking.
3. **Call and get an AED.** Call emergency services, or point to a specific person: “You—call **[VERIFY: local emergency number]** and bring the AED.” Put a mobile phone on speaker so the call-taker can coach you.
4. **Begin hands-only CPR.** Place the person face-up on a firm, flat surface. Kneel beside the chest. Put the heel of one hand in the center of the chest, place the other hand on top, and interlock your fingers.

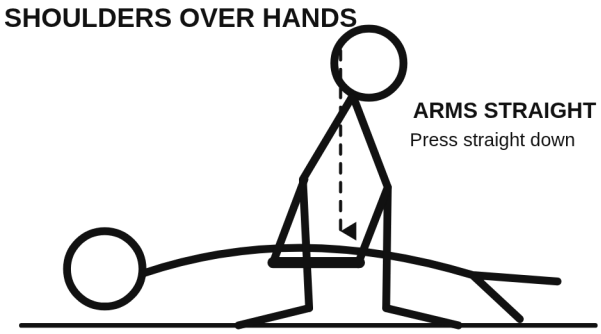


Hand position. Center of the chest, on the breastbone. Original diagram checked against the 2025 AHA CPR/ECC Guidelines.

SKL-006

UNDER-REVIEW

Hands-Only CPR & AED Orientation — continued



Body posture. Shoulders over straight arms; press vertically.
Original diagram checked against the 2025 AHA CPR/ECC Guidelines.

PUSH HARD AND FAST

- Push straight down at **100–120 compressions a minute**.
- For an average adult, compress **at least 2 inches (5 cm)** but not more than 2.4 inches (6 cm).
- Let the chest return fully after every push. Keep pauses as short as possible.
- Continue until an AED tells you to pause, the person shows signs of life, trained help takes over, the scene becomes unsafe, or you are too exhausted to continue.

SKL-006

Hands-Only CPR & AED Orientation — continued

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

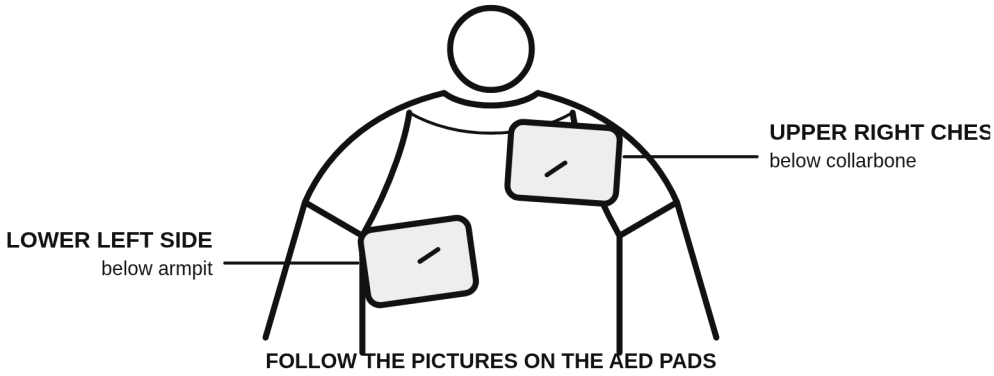
Hands-only CPR is for a teen or adult who suddenly collapses. People trained and willing to give breaths should use the CPR method taught in their current course.

Hands-Only CPR & AED Orientation — continued

Use an AED as soon as it arrives. It will analyze the heart rhythm and gives a shock only when indicated.

USE THE AED: TURN IT ON AND LISTEN

1. **Turn on the AED.** Open the lid or press the power button. Follow every visual and spoken prompt. Continue CPR while another rescuer prepares the AED, if possible.
2. **Bare and prepare the chest.** Remove clothing. If the chest is wet, dry it quickly. Use the AED kit and follow its prompts for medication patches or heavy chest hair; do not delay unnecessarily.
3. **Attach the pads.** Peel off the backing and press pads firmly to the bare chest exactly as the pictures on the pads show. Use adult pads for an adult.



Common adult anterolateral placement. One pad below the right collarbone; one on the lower left side below the armpit. The pictures on the actual pads control.
Original diagram checked against the 2025 AHA CPR/ECC Guidelines.

1. **Clear for analysis.** Say “Clear!” and make sure nobody is touching the person while the AED analyzes.
2. **If a shock is advised, clear again.** Look from head to toe, loudly say “Clear,” and make sure nobody is touching the person. Press the flashing shock button if prompted. A fully automatic AED may deliver the shock itself.
3. **Resume CPR immediately.** Start compressions again and follow the AED prompts. Keep going until trained help takes over or the person shows signs of life. Leave pads attached.

△ **CAUTION — PREVENT HARM**

Water and electricity: do not use an AED while the person is in water or while you are standing in water. Move to a safe, dry surface if this can be done safely; dry the chest and follow the device prompts.

DIFFERENT EMERGENCIES NEED CURRENT TRAINING

Children and infants: Ages, techniques, compression depth, breaths, when to call, and pediatric AED use differ. Take a current pediatric CPR/AED course; do not use this adult quick sequence as pediatric instruction. Follow the call-taker and AED prompts in an emergency.

Drowning: Rescue breaths are especially important after drowning, and water rescue adds hazards. Take current drowning-response CPR and water-safety training. Never enter water unless trained and it is safe; call emergency services and follow the call-taker’s directions.

UNDER-REVIEW

Hands-Only CPR & AED Orientation — continued

PRACTICE AND LOCALIZE BEFORE USE

- **Recommended:** instructor-led, hands-on practice with feedback manikins and AED trainers, followed by the course’s required skills check.
- **Local course providers: [VERIFY: list current qualified CPR/AED course providers, registration links, languages, accessibility, and cost]**
- **Required technical review: [VERIFY: name, current CPR/AED instructor credential or medical qualification, credential expiration if applicable, and review date]**

Hands-Only CPR & AED Orientation — continued

SOURCES

Guideline edition used for content and all three diagrams: *2025 American Heart Association Guidelines for Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation and Emergency Cardiovascular Care*, published October 22, 2025: cpr.heart.org/en/resuscitation-science/cpr-and-ecc-guidelines. American Heart Association, “Hands-Only CPR”: cpr.heart.org/en/cpr-courses-and-kits/hands-only-cpr. Accessed 2026-09-29. Recheck against the current edition during required qualified review.